and Shroff's criticism of the policies of the government grew more trenchant. Shroff was not against planning but he felt that Nehru's brand of socialism which pervaded all aspects of life was turning India into a totalitarian state. In 1936, when Nehru had advocated socialism at the Lucknow session of the Indian National Congress, Shroff, then Vice Chairman of the IMC, had set out his concerns in an article in *The Times of India*. A day later on May 20, 1936, twenty-one business leaders which included Sir Cowasji Jehangir, Sir Purshotamdas Thakurdas, Homi Mody, Walchand Hirachand, and A.D. Shroff sent Nehru a public message by publishing a manifesto in the same paper.

The restrictions on private enterprise increased—nationalisation, licensing and quotas. Rampant corruption, which in a way was a direct consequence of the licence-permit raj, made matters worse. It was in this atmosphere that Shroff started the Forum of Free Enterprise as a vehicle to counter government propaganda against the private sector, believing that educating the public opinion was the best antidote to the doctrinaire policies of the government. At that time the Congress who ruled both at the Centre and in the States was becoming increasingly intolerant of, and hostile to, criticism.

Shroff fearlessly criticised the government's policies, and his Forum of Free Enterprise was set up precisely to provide a forum from where public opinion would be stirred and government urged to see the other viewpoint. The government however chose only to highlight his advocacy of free enterprise and *laissez faire*, conveniently overlooking the fact that Shroff had always accepted the need for planning in order to reduce inequality. As C.D. Deshmukh observed in his A.D. Shroff Memorial Lecture in 1970, 'It was his realism that made him a champion of free enterprise. Patriotism is not the monopoly of those professing some brand of socialism or another. Patriotism can coexist with a judicious bias in favour of free enterprise. A.D. Shroff was a notable exemplar of this truth.'[1] Minoo Shroff, A.D. Shroff's nephew observes: 'He was a staunch patriot. Even at the height of his campaign against the policies of the government he would advise many potential foreign investors to invest in India as he was convinced of India's ultimate destiny as a great economic power based on its huge market and robust entrepreneurial class. Consequently he was able to attract many